Not One Stone *Upon Another*

What did the disciples hear?

▶ Watch on YouTube | Read Matthew 24:1-35 in the LSB | 37:59 | Channel: Every Word

Full title: The Hidden Clue in the Olivet Discourse (REVEALED). Series: The Gospel of Matthew Every Word (playlist of 58 videos).

FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND (ADDED) · DEBATED · LSB TEXT · ◆ LOGOS FACTBOOK LINK

01 · FROM THE VIDEO

Short summary

- The teacher reads Matthew 24:1-35. As Jesus leaves the temple, the disciples point out its buildings, and He says not one stone will be left upon another. On the Mount of Olives they ask: 'when will these things happen, and what will be the sign of Your coming and of the end of the age?' Jesus warns of deceivers, wars, famines and earthquakes ('the beginning of birth pains'), persecution, and the abomination of desolation; those in Judea must flee to the mountains. After the tribulation come cosmic signs and the Son of Man coming on the clouds. Learn from the fig tree: this generation will not pass away until all these things take place.
- This begins Jesus' fifth and final discourse, on judgment (chapters 24 and 25); the video sees the five discourses as paralleling the five books of the Torah. Christians are divided over this passage.
- The key is the disciples' question. It follows straight from 23:35-39, the judgment on the leaders, the city and the temple. The video reads it as one question about one event: many Jews spoke of this age and the age to come, and the disciples, picturing Daniel 7:13-14, linked the temple's fall with Jesus' coming and the end of the corrupt age.
- Jesus answers in the prophets' apocalyptic style, full of Old Testament allusions (Deuteronomy 13, Daniel 9, 11 and 12, Joel 2, Zechariah 14 and more). He keeps saying

> *"If God's people will filter the events taking place around them through the lens of his word, they will have the discernment to understand his activity.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

> *"What did the disciples think that Jesus meant?*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

'you.' Luke's parallel explains the abomination: 'when you see Jerusalem surrounded by armies' (Luke 21:20). The video holds that the discourse is about the destruction of the temple in AD 70, while acknowledging that others disagree.

- The lesson: if God's people will filter the events taking place around them through the lens of His word, they will have the discernment to understand His activity.

Hear it as the first listeners did

Before asking what the passage means for us, ask what the disciples sitting on the Mount of Olives would have heard.

The video reads from another English translation. Quotations on this page are from the LSB. This is Episode 46 of the Matthew study (playlist item 49).

02 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

Scripture passages covered

The video reads all of Matthew 24:1-35 and turns to Matthew 16, 20 and 23, Daniel 7, 9, 11 and 12, Luke 7 and 21, Joel 2, Zechariah 14, Acts 3, Romans 11 and John 5. Each link opens those verses on read.lsbible.org.

Matthew 24:1-35
Read in full: the first part of the Olivet Discourse.

Matthew 23:35-39
The judgment just pronounced on the leaders, the city and the temple.

Daniel 7:13-14
One like a Son of Man with the clouds of heaven.

Matthew 16:21-22
Peter rebukes Jesus.

Matthew 20:21
Seats at His right and left.

Luke 7:19
John asks from prison.

Daniel 9:27
On the wing of abominations.

Daniel 11:31
The abomination of desolation.

Daniel 12:11
The regular sacrifice abolished.

Luke 21:20-22
Jerusalem surrounded by armies.

Joel 2:10
The sun and the moon grow dark.

Zechariah 14:4
His feet on the Mount of Olives.

Acts 3:19-21
Until the period of restoration of all things.

Romans 11:25-26
All Israel will be saved.

John 5:19
Only what He sees the Father doing.

Key verses in the LSB

"Truly I say to you, not one stone here will be left upon another, which will not be torn down."
Matthew 24:2 (LSB)

"Tell us, when will these things happen, and what will be the sign of Your coming and of the end of the age?"
Matthew 24:3 (LSB)

"Heaven and earth will pass away, but My words will not pass away."
Matthew 24:35 (LSB)

03 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

The disciples' question

Not one stone, one question, and the prophets' way of speaking.

MATTHEW 24:1-2

Not one stone

MATTHEW 24:1-2 (LSB) PROPHECY

"And coming out from the temple, Jesus was going along, and His disciples came up to point out the temple buildings to Him. And He answered and said to them, "Do you not see all these things? Truly I say to you, not one stone here will be left upon another, which will not be torn down.""

FROM THE VIDEO Jesus has just said, 'your house is being left to you desolate' (23:38). Leaving the temple, He says it again: the buildings will be torn down. Matthew 23:38

FROM THE VIDEO A little shy of 40 years later the Romans sacked the city and the temple. Jesus was absolutely correct.

BACKGROUND Herod's temple was still being finished; Josephus describes stones of enormous size.

◆ Factbook: Temple (Jewish) ◆ Factbook: Herod the Great

MATTHEW 24:3; DANIEL 7:13-14

One question, two ages

THE DISCIPLES · MATTHEW 24:3

“Now as He was sitting on the Mount of Olives, the disciples came to Him privately, saying, “Tell us, when will these things happen, and what will be the sign of Your coming and of the end of the age?””

DANIEL · DANIEL 7:14

“And to Him was given dominion, / Glory, and a kingdom, / That all the peoples, nations, and men of every tongue / Might serve Him. / His dominion is an everlasting dominion / Which will not be taken away; / And His kingdom is one / Which will not be destroyed.”

FROM THE VIDEO Many Jews spoke of two ages: this corrupt age, under Greek influence and Roman rule, and the age to come, the age of the Messiah. The disciples saw the temple's fall as the end of this age.

FROM THE VIDEO That is why Peter rebuked Jesus (16:22), James and John asked for seats (20:21), and John asked from prison (Luke 7:19): they expected a kingdom of military dominance. Matthew 16:22 · Matthew 20:21 · Luke 7:19

BACKGROUND The Mishnah keeps both ages: 'this world is like a vestibule before the world to come' (Pirkei Avot 4:16), and 'The days of your life, refers to the days in this world, all is added to include the days of the Messiah' (Mishnah Berakhot 1:5).

◆ Factbook: Mount of Olives · ◆ Factbook: Eschatology · ◆ Factbook: Ancient of Days · ◆ Factbook: Son of Man

MATTHEW 24:4-14

The prophets' way of speaking

MATTHEW 24:6-8 (LSB) APOCALYPTIC

“And you are going to hear of wars and rumors of wars. See that you are not alarmed, for those things must take place, but that is not yet the end. For nation will rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom, and in various places there will be famines and earthquakes. But all these things are merely the beginning of birth pains.”

FROM THE VIDEO Why not just say, 'In 37 years, on a Tuesday at 3:00 p.m., the Romans will destroy the temple'? Because the prophets spoke in layered images that connect back to God's word. Prophecy communicates what God is saying and stands on what He has already spoken.

FROM THE VIDEO The video's chart: false messiahs (Deuteronomy 13; Jeremiah 23), wars (Isaiah 19; Ezekiel 38-39), the abomination (Daniel 9, 11, 12), fleeing to the mountains (Zechariah 14), cosmic signs (Isaiah 13; Joel 2). Deuteronomy 13:1-3 · Isaiah 13:10

◆ Factbook: The Prophets (books) · ◆ Factbook: False prophet · ◆ Factbook: Persecution



Do you not see all these things?

James Tissot, The Disciples Admire the Buildings of the Temple, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *"What did the disciples think that Jesus meant?*
>
> From the video

04 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

The abomination and the signs

Daniel, Luke's armies, and the cosmic language of judgment.

MATTHEW 24:15-16; LUKE 21:20

The abomination of desolation

JESUS IN MATTHEW · MATTHEW 24:15-16

""Therefore when you see the abomination of desolation which was spoken of through Daniel the prophet, standing in the holy place (let the reader understand), then those who are in Judea must flee to the mountains."

JESUS IN LUKE · LUKE 21:20

""But when you see Jerusalem surrounded by armies, then know that its desolation is at hand."

FROM THE VIDEO Many today think of a future Antichrist in a rebuilt temple. Luke's account shows what the disciples heard: Jerusalem surrounded by the Roman army, which desolated the city and the temple in AD 70.

FROM THE VIDEO The phrase recalls Antiochus IV Epiphanes, who desecrated the temple and offered pagan sacrifices there (Daniel 11:31). Daniel 11:31

BACKGROUND Josephus says that as the sanctuary burned, the Romans brought their standards into the temple court and sacrificed to them (Jewish War 6.316).

◆ Factbook: Daniel (the prophet) ◆ Factbook: Flavius Josephus

MATTHEW 24:16-28

Flee, and do not be deceived

🏃 MATTHEW 24:23-26 (LSB)

STAY CALM

“Then if anyone says to you, ‘Behold, here is the Christ,’ or ‘There He is,’ do not believe him. For false christs and false prophets will arise and will show great signs and wonders, so as to deceive, if possible, even the elect. Behold, I have told you in advance. Therefore, if they say to you, ‘Behold, He is in the wilderness,’ do not go out, or, ‘Behold, He is in the inner rooms,’ do not believe them.”

FROM THE VIDEO Two things stand out in Jesus' answer: events around the temple's fall would confuse many, so He warns against deceivers (24:4, 11, 24) and commands calm (24:6, 23, 26).

FROM THE VIDEO Second, the copious Old Testament allusions: to interpret prophecy, God's people need to know God's word.

◆ Factbook: False prophet ◆ Factbook: Wilderness

MATTHEW 24:29-31; ISAIAH 13:10

Sun, moon and stars

JESUS · MATTHEW 24:29

““But immediately after the tribulation of those days the sun will be darkened, and the moon will not give its light, and the stars will fall from the sky, and the powers of the heavens will be shaken.”

ISAIAH, AGAINST BABYLON · ISAIAH 13:10

“For the stars of heaven and their constellations / Will not flash forth their light; / The sun will be dark when it rises / And the moon will not shed its light.”

FROM THE VIDEO This is how Jewish prophets spoke about coming judgment. Isaiah used these images for the fall of Babylon (Isaiah 13:1, 10), Joel for the day of Yahweh (Joel 2:10). Joel 2:10

BACKGROUND The Son of Man 'coming on the clouds' (24:30) quotes Daniel 7:13, where one like a Son of Man comes up to the Ancient of Days. Daniel 7:13

◆ Factbook: Day of the Lord ◆ Factbook: Isaiah ◆ Factbook: Babylon ◆ Factbook: Joel (the prophet)



Jerusalem surrounded by armies

David Roberts, The Siege and Destruction of Jerusalem by the Romans Under the Command of Titus, A.D. 70, 1850. Via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *“Prophecy is not merely about telling the future.*
>
> From the video

05 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

Learn from the fig tree

This generation, a study trail, and seeing what God is doing.

MATTHEW 24:32-35

Learn from the fig tree

🌿 MATTHEW 24:32-34 (LSB)

THIS GENERATION

““Now learn the parable from the fig tree: when its branch has already become tender and puts forth its leaves, you know that summer is near; so, you too, when you see all these things, recognize that He is near, right at the door. Truly I say to you, this generation will not pass away until all these things take place.”

FROM THE VIDEO Jesus uses 'you' and 'your' again and again from 24:3 on: these things will happen to the disciples and their generation.

FROM THE VIDEO Jesus uses 'see' and 'look' repeatedly: 'when you see all these things.' Signs are for those who know God's word.

◆ Factbook: Fig tree

ACTS 3:21; ROMANS 11:25-26

Following the rabbit trail

PETER · ACTS 3:21

“whom heaven must receive until the period of restoration of all things about which God spoke by the mouth of His holy prophets from ancient time.”

PAUL · ROMANS 11:26

“and so all Israel will be saved; just as it is written, / “The Deliverer will come from Zion, / He will remove ungodliness from Jacob.””

FROM THE VIDEO The video asks a Bible software study tool how first-century Jews understood the end of the age, then compares Peter's words on the restoration with Paul in Romans 11.

BACKGROUND Paul's birth-pain image is in Romans 8:22: 'the whole creation groans and suffers the pains of childbirth together until now.' Romans 8:22

◆ Factbook: Peter (Simon Peter) ◆ Factbook: Paul

JOHN 5:19

See what the Father is doing

👀 JOHN 5:19 (LSB)

LESSON

“Therefore Jesus answered and was saying to them, “Truly, truly, I say to you, the Son can do nothing from Himself, unless it is something He sees the Father doing; for whatever the Father does, these

things the Son also does in the same manner."

FROM THE VIDEO As God's adopted children, we should be able to survey our own circumstances and recognize the activity of God, through His word, and then go and be a part of it.

FROM THE VIDEO If God's people will filter the events taking place around them through the lens of His word, they will have the discernment to understand His activity.

◆ Factbook: God the Son



On the Mount of Olives, facing the temple

James Tissot, The Prophecy of the Destruction of the Temple, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *"Why would Jesus answer a question that the disciples were not asking?*
>
> From the video

06

Who's who in 24:1-35

What the video says, then a short background note.

The disciples

VIDEO Point out the temple buildings, then ask one question about its fall.

BACKGROUND Mark 13:3 names Peter, James, John and Andrew.

Matthew 24:1-3 | Mark 13:3 | ◆ Disciples | ◆ Peter (Simon Peter) | ◆ Andrew (apostle)

Daniel

VIDEO The prophet of the Son of Man and the abomination of desolation.

BACKGROUND Jesus calls him 'Daniel the prophet' (24:15).

Daniel 7:13-14 | Daniel 11:31 | ◆ Daniel (the prophet)

Antiochus IV Epiphanes

VIDEO Desecrated the temple before Jesus' day.

The Romans

BACKGROUND Seleucid king; the temple was rededicated under the Maccabees, remembered at Hanukkah (John 10:22).

Daniel 11:31 | John 10:22 | ◆ Antiochus IV Epiphanes

VIDEO Surrounded Jerusalem and destroyed the temple in AD 70.

BACKGROUND Titus, son of the emperor Vespasian, led the siege.

Luke 21:20 | ◆ Titus (emperor) | ◆ Vespasian

Josephus

VIDEO Says the Roman soldiers worshiped their standards in the temple.

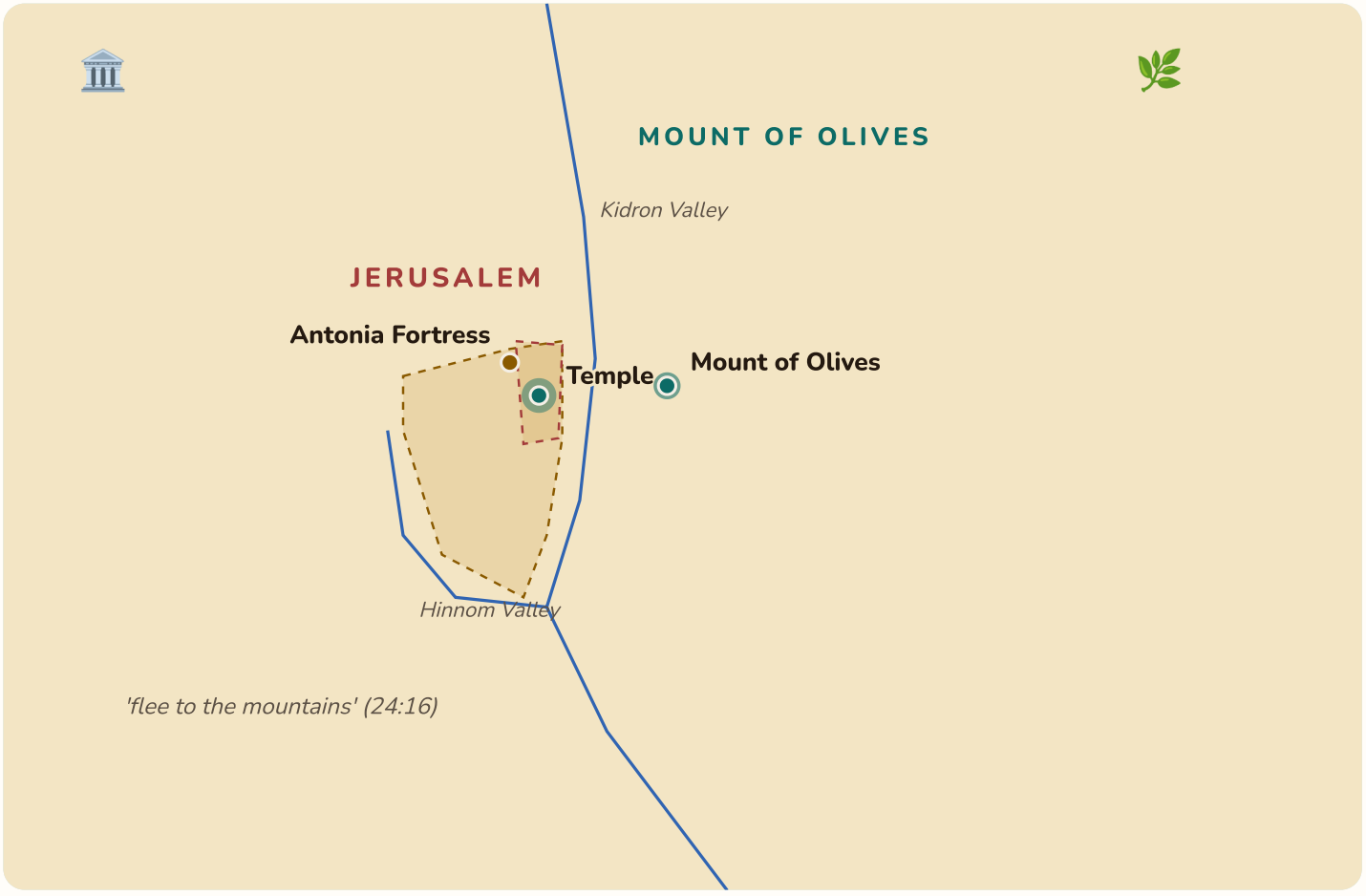
BACKGROUND Jewish historian who witnessed the siege and wrote the Jewish War.

Matthew 24:15 | ◆ Flavius Josephus

07 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND

From the temple to the Mount of Olives

Pins outlined in the video's color are places the video names. Gold pins are background.



Schematic: drawn for this study from known sites. Walls (gold dashes) and the temple platform (coral dashes) are approximate for the first century.

Temple VIDEO

'Not one stone here will be left upon another' (24:2).

◆ Factbook: Temple (Jewish)

Mount of Olives VIDEO

Where Jesus sat with the disciples, facing the temple (24:3).

◆ Factbook: Mount of Olives

Antonia Fortress BACKGROUND

Roman garrison beside the temple; Titus's legions took it before the temple fell.

◆ Factbook: Tower of Antonia

08

Key terms

Olivet Discourse

VIDEO

Jesus' teaching on the Mount of Olives (Matthew 24-25), His fifth and last discourse.

◆ Factbook: Mount of Olives

This age and the age to come

VIDEO

The Jewish hope that the Messiah would end this corrupt age and bring the age to come.

◆ Factbook: Eschatology

Birth pains

VIDEO

Labor pains, an image of the troubles before God's new age (24:8).

◆ Factbook: Birth pangs

Abomination of desolation

VIDEO

Daniel's phrase for a desecration of the temple (Daniel 9:27; 11:31; 12:11).

◆ Factbook: Daniel (the prophet)

◆ Factbook: Abomination of desolation

Apocalyptic

VIDEO

Revelatory language of cosmic signs and judgment, used by the prophets.

◆ Factbook: The Prophets (books)

Preterism

BACKGROUND

The view that much or all of the discourse was fulfilled in AD 70.

◆ Factbook: Preterism

09 · BACKGROUND

Hebrew, Aramaic and Greek words

Strong's numbers match the LSB's own word tagging for the verses listed. Glosses summarize the standard lexicons; 'Look up' points you to the entry to read for yourself (BDAG for Greek; BDB or HALOT for Hebrew and Aramaic).

παρουσία

parousia `G3952`

Coming, arrival, presence. Look up: BDAG, παρουσία.

Greek · Matt 24:3, 27

συντέλεια

synteleia `G4930`

Completion, end.

Greek · Matt 24:3

αἰών

aiōn `G165`

Age, era.

Greek · Matt 24:3

◆ Factbook: Eschatology

ὠδίν

ōdin `G5604`

Birth pain, labor pang.

Greek · Matt 24:8

◆ Factbook: Birth pangs

βδέλυγμα

bdelygma `G946`

Abomination, detestable thing.

Greek · Matt 24:15

◆ Factbook: Abomination of desolation

ἐρήμωσις

erēmōsis `G2050`

Desolation, laying waste.

Greek · Matt 24:15

θλῖψις

thlipsis `G2347`

Tribulation, affliction.

Greek · Matt 24:21

γενεά

genea `G1074`

Generation, the people of a time.

Greek · Matt 24:34

שִׁקּוּץ

shiqquts `H8251`

Detestable thing, abomination (of idols).

Hebrew · Dan 11:31

◆ Factbook: Abomination of desolation

שָׁמֵם

shamem `H8074`

To be desolate, appalled; makes desolate.

Hebrew · Dan 11:31

בַּר אֱנָשׁ

bar enash `H1247`

Aramaic: son of man, a human being (with H606).

Aramaic · Dan 7:13

◆ Factbook: Son of Man

10

Historical and cultural background

ESTABLISHED Facts most interpreters agree on

The Jewish War

The revolt against Rome began in AD 66. Vespasian subdued Galilee first; his son Titus besieged Jerusalem in AD 70, and the temple burned in the late summer of that year.

Antiochus IV Epiphanes

In 167 BC the Seleucid king stopped the sacrifices and defiled the temple with pagan worship. 1 Maccabees calls it a desolating sacrilege on the altar; the temple was cleansed and rededicated three years later.

Two ages

Later rabbinic texts speak of 'this world' and 'the world to come,' and of 'the days of the Messiah' in between (Mishnah Berakhot 1:5; Pirkei Avot 4:16).

SOURCED Early witnesses

> *And this gospel shall be preached in the whole world for a witness to all nations, and then shall the end come, of the downfall of Jerusalem.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 75, on 24:14. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

> *Whence he seems to me to be speaking of the armies.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 76, on 24:15. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

> *Peruse the history about these things composed by Josephus, and you will know all accurately.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 75, on 24:7. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

DEBATED Where scholars differ

AD 70, the end, or both?

The video holds that the discourse is about the destruction of the temple in AD 70 (a preterist reading). Others read it as about the end of history, and many see both: the near event of AD 70 as a pattern of the final coming.

One question or several?

The video reads 24:3 as one question about one event. Others see two or three questions (the temple's fall; the coming; the end of the age), with Jesus answering each.

Five discourses like five books?

Many note five long discourses in Matthew, each ending 'when Jesus had finished' (7:28; 11:1; 13:53; 19:1; 26:1). Whether they deliberately mirror the five books of Moses is debated.

CAREFUL READING

Small slips in the video

Small slips worth knowing (offered gently; the video's main points stand):

- The words about heaven receiving Jesus 'until the period of restoration of all things' are from Peter's sermon in Acts 3:21, not his epistle.
- The labor-pain image the study tool attributes to Romans 11 is in Romans 8:22.
- The sources for Antiochus describe pagan sacrifices and a 'desolating sacrilege' on the altar; the statue of Zeus is a later report.
- Josephus places the Roman standards in the temple court while the sanctuary was burning, not after the temple was destroyed (Jewish War 6.316).
- Counts of 'you' and 'see' depend on the translation; the LSB numbers differ slightly.

II · BACKGROUND

From Daniel to Chrysostom

Coral dots mark what Matthew 24:1-35 echoes or this episode covers. Early dates are approximate; dates tagged debated vary among scholars.

6TH C. BC DEBATED
Daniel's vision of the Son of Man
Daniel 7:13-14 *Echoed: 24:30*

167 BC DEBATED
Antiochus IV defiles the temple
Daniel 11:31

C. AD 30 DEBATED
The Olivet Discourse
Matthew 24:1-35 *This episode*

AD 66
The Jewish revolt begins
Matthew 24:6

AD 70
Jerusalem and the temple destroyed
Matthew 24:2

C. AD 75
Josephus writes the Jewish War
Luke 21:20

C. AD 390
Chrysostom: 'the downfall of Jerusalem'
Matthew 24:14

12

Cross-references

Added cross-references for further study.

Mark 13:1-31
Mark's account
ADDED

Luke 21:5-33
Luke's account
ADDED

Luke 19:41-44
Jesus weeps over the city
ADDED

Deuteronomy 13:1-5
Testing a false prophet
ADDED

Zechariah 14:1-5
The day of Yahweh and the Mount of Olives
ADDED

13

Reflection and discussion

0 of 6 questions marked done on this device.

1 ☐ What did the disciples most likely mean by 'the end of the age'?

2 ☐ Why does Jesus answer in images rather than dates?

3 ☐ How does Luke 21:20 help you read Matthew 24:15?

4 ☐ Which Old Testament passage behind this chapter would you like to study first?

5 ☐ Why does Jesus keep telling them not to be alarmed or deceived?

6 ☐ Where do you see God at work around you right now, and how does His word help you see it?

14

Application

FROM THE VIDEO

The lesson: if God's people will filter the events taking place around them through the lens of His word, they will have the discernment to understand His activity. Jesus spoke apocalyptically to send His disciples back to God's word, so they would know not only when the temple would fall, but why, and how to discern the moment. The same holds for us: like the Son who does what He sees the Father doing (John 5:19), we should survey our circumstances, recognize God's activity through His word, and go and be a part of it.

STUDY NOTE (ADDED)

pick one allusion from the video's chart this week, read the Old Testament passage in full, and note what it adds to Matthew 24.

> *"If God's people will filter the events taking place around them through the lens of his word, they will have the discernment to understand his activity.*
>
> From the video

15

Look it up in Logos

Each link opens that person, place or topic in the Logos Factbook, inside the Logos app on iPad, Mac or PC. The same links are in Copy all notes.

◆ Jesus Christ ◆ Moses ◆ Isaiah ◆ Wilderness ◆ Flavius Josephus ◆ Judgment ◆ Galilee
◆ Temple (Jewish) ◆ Jerusalem ◆ Book of Deuteronomy ◆ Worship ◆ God the Son ◆ John Chrysostom
◆ Andrew (apostle) ◆ Disciples ◆ Ezekiel (prophet) ◆ James (son of Zebedee) ◆ Jeremiah (prophet)
◆ John (son of Zebedee) ◆ Judea ◆ Law of Moses ◆ Mishnah ◆ Persecution ◆ Peter (Simon Peter)
◆ Valley of Hinnom ◆ Daniel (the prophet) ◆ False prophet ◆ Joel (the prophet) ◆ Paul ◆ Son of Man
◆ Ancient of Days ◆ Babylon ◆ Eschatology ◆ Messiah ◆ Parable ◆ Day of the Lord
◆ Tower of Antonia ◆ Fig tree ◆ Idolatry ◆ Mount of Olives ◆ Abomination of desolation

◆ Antiochus IV Epiphanes ◆ Birth pangs ◆ Preterism ◆ Titus (emperor) ◆ Vespasian

Source: the video's auto-generated YouTube captions, read in full. Scripture quotations are from the Legacy Standard Bible, copyright 2021 by The Lockman Foundation. All rights reserved. Chrysostom: Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers (public domain). Mishnah Berakhot: Sefaria, William Davidson Edition (CC BY-NC); Pirkei Avot: Sefaria, Mishnah Yomit by Dr. Joshua Kulp (CC BY). Images: Wikimedia Commons (James Tissot, Brooklyn Museum; David Roberts; public domain). Map: drawn for this study.

Offline copy. Live page: https://shea-nelson.github.io/workout-app/bible/matthew-46/